

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

# **BibInVs MN 52**

## **Thessalonians1**

*Bible Translation:*  
*Interverse MSG/NIV - 52*

**God**

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# Interversed Message/NIV Bible

## 1 Thessalonians

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### 1 Thessalonians 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 I, Paul, together here with Silas and Timothy, send greetings to the church at Thessalonica, Christians assembled by God the Father and by the Master, Jesus Christ. God's amazing grace be with you! God's robust peace!
- 1 Paul, Silas and Timothy, To the church of the Thessalonians in God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ: Grace and peace to you.
- 2 Every time we think of you, we thank God for you. Day and night you're in our prayers
- 2 We always thank God for all of you, mentioning you in our prayers.
- 3 as we call to mind your work of faith, your labor of love, and your patience of hope in following our Master, Jesus Christ, before God our Father.
- 3 We continually remember before our God and Father your work produced by faith, your labor prompted by love, and your endurance inspired by hope in our Lord Jesus Christ.
- 4 It is clear to us, friends, that God not only loves you very much but also has put his hand on you for something special.
- 4 For we know, brothers loved by God, that he has chosen you,
- 5 When the Message we preached came to you, it wasn't just words. Something happened in you. The Holy Spirit put steel in your convictions. You paid careful attention to the way we lived among you,
- 5 because our gospel came to you not simply with words, but also with power, with the Holy Spirit and with deep conviction. You know how we lived among you for your sake.
- 6 and determined to live that way yourselves. In imitating us, you imitated the Master. Although great trouble accompanied the Word, you were

- able to take great joy from the Holy Spirit!--taking the trouble with the joy, the joy with the trouble.
- 6 You became imitators of us and of the Lord; in spite of severe suffering, you welcomed the message with the joy given by the Holy Spirit.
- 7 Do you know that all over the provinces of both Macedonia and Achaia believers look up to you?
- 7 And so you became a model to all the believers in Macedonia and Achaia.
- 8 The word has gotten around. Your lives are echoing the Master's Word, not only in the provinces but all over the place. The news of your faith in God is out. We don't even have to say anything anymore--you're the message!
- 8 The Lord's message rang out from you not only in Macedonia and Achaia--your faith in God has become known everywhere. Therefore we do not need to say anything about it,
- 9 People come up and tell us how you received us with open arms, how you deserted the dead idols of your old life so you could embrace and serve God, the true God.
- 9 for they themselves report what kind of reception you gave us. They tell how you turned to God from idols to serve the living and true God,
- 10 They marvel at how expectantly you await the arrival of his Son, whom he raised from the dead--Jesus, who rescued us from certain doom.
- 10 and to wait for his Son from heaven, whom he raised from the dead--Jesus, who rescues us from the coming wrath.

## **1 Thessalonians 2**

MSG

NIV

- 1 So, friends, it's obvious that our visit to you was no waste of time.
- 1 You know, brothers, that our visit to you was not a failure.
- 2 We had just been given rough treatment in Philippi, as you know, but that didn't slow us down. We were sure of ourselves in God, and went right ahead and said our piece, presenting God's Message to you, defiant of the opposition.

- 2 We had previously suffered and been insulted in Philippi, as you know, but with the help of our God we dared to tell you his gospel in spite of strong opposition.
- 3 God tested us thoroughly to make sure we were qualified to be trusted with this Message.
- 3 For the appeal we make does not spring from error or impure motives, nor are we trying to trick you.
- 4 Be assured that when we speak to you we're not after crowd approval--only God approval. Since we've been put through that battery of tests, you're guaranteed that both we and the Message are free of error, mixed motives, or hidden agendas.
- 4 On the contrary, we speak as men approved by God to be entrusted with the gospel. We are not trying to please men but God, who tests our hearts.
- 5 We never used words to butter you up. No one knows that better than you. And God knows we never used words as a smoke screen to take advantage of you.
- 5 You know we never used flattery, nor did we put on a mask to cover up greed--God is our witness.
- 6 Even though we had some standing as Christ's apostles, we never threw our weight around or tried to come across as important, with you or anyone else.
- 6 We were not looking for praise from men, not from you or anyone else. As apostles of Christ we could have been a burden to you,
- 7 We weren't aloof with you. We took you just as you were. We were never patronizing, never condescending, but we cared for you the way a mother cares for her children.
- 7 but we were gentle among you, like a mother caring for her little children.
- 8 We loved you dearly. Not content to just pass on the Message, we wanted to give you our hearts. And we did.
- 8 We loved you so much that we were delighted to share with you not only the gospel of God but our lives as well, because you had become so dear to us.
- 9 You remember us in those days, friends, working our fingers to the bone, up half the night, moonlighting so you wouldn't have the burden of

supporting us while we proclaimed God's Message to you.

- 9 Surely you remember, brothers, our toil and hardship; we worked night and day in order not to be a burden to anyone while we preached the gospel of God to you.
- 10 You saw with your own eyes how discreet and courteous we were among you, with keen sensitivity to you as fellow believers. And God knows we weren't freeloaders!
- 10 You are witnesses, and so is God, of how holy, righteous and blameless we were among you who believed.
- 11 You experienced it all firsthand. With each of you we were like a father with his child,
- 11 For you know that we dealt with each of you as a father deals with his own children,
- 12 holding your hand, whispering encouragement, showing you step-by-step how to live well before God, who called us into his own kingdom, into this delightful life.
- 12 encouraging, comforting and urging you to live lives worthy of God, who calls you into his kingdom and glory.
- 13 And now we look back on all this and thank God, an artesian well of thanks! When you got the Message of God we preached, you didn't pass it off as just one more human opinion, but you took it to heart as God's true word to you, which it is, God himself at work in you believers!
- 13 And we also thank God continually because, when you received the word of God, which you heard from us, you accepted it not as the word of men, but as it actually is, the word of God, which is at work in you who believe.
- 14 Friends, do you realize that you followed in the exact footsteps of the churches of God in Judea, those who were the first to follow in the footsteps of Jesus Christ? You got the same bad treatment from your countrymen as they did from theirs, the Jews
- 14 For you, brothers, became imitators of God's churches in Judea, which are in Christ Jesus: You suffered from your own countrymen the same things those churches suffered from the Jews,
- 15 who killed the Master Jesus (to say nothing of the prophets) and followed it up by running us out of town. They make themselves offensive to God and everyone else

- 15 who killed the Lord Jesus and the prophets and also drove us out. They displease God and are hostile to all men
- 16 by trying to keep us from telling people who've never heard of our God how to be saved. They've made a career of opposing God, and have gotten mighty good at it. But God is fed up, ready to put an end to it.
- 16 in their effort to keep us from speaking to the Gentiles so that they may be saved. In this way they always heap up their sins to the limit. The wrath of God has come upon them at last.
- 17 Do you have any idea how very homesick we became for you, dear friends? Even though it hadn't been that long and it was only our bodies that were separated from you, not our hearts, we tried our very best to get back to see you.
- 17 But, brothers, when we were torn away from you for a short time (in person, not in thought), out of our intense longing we made every effort to see you.
- 18 You can't imagine how much we missed you! I, Paul, tried over and over to get back, but Satan stymied us each time.
- 18 For we wanted to come to you-- certainly I, Paul, did, again and again-- but Satan stopped us.
- 19 Who do you think we're going to be proud of when our Master Jesus appears if it's not you?
- 19 For what is our hope, our joy, or the crown in which we will glory in the presence of our Lord Jesus when he comes? Is it not you?
- 20 You're our pride and joy!
- 20 Indeed, you are our glory and joy.

## **1 Thessalonians 3**

MSG

NIV

- 1 So when we couldn't stand being separated from you any longer and could find no way to visit you ourselves, we stayed in Athens
- 1 So when we could stand it no longer, we thought it best to be left by ourselves in Athens.
- 2 and sent Timothy to get you up and about, cheering you on so you wouldn't be discouraged by these hard times. He's a brother and

companion in the faith, God's man in spreading the Message, preaching Christ.

- 2 We sent Timothy, who is our brother and God's fellow worker in spreading the gospel of Christ, to strengthen and encourage you in your faith,
- 3 Not that the troubles should come as any surprise to you. You've always known that we're in for this kind of thing. It's part of our calling.
- 3 so that no one would be unsettled by these trials. You know quite well that we were destined for them.
- 4 When we were with you, we made it quite clear that there was trouble ahead. And now that it's happened, you know what it's like.
- 4 In fact, when we were with you, we kept telling you that we would be persecuted. And it turned out that way, as you well know.
- 5 That's why I couldn't quit worrying; I had to know for myself how you were doing in the faith. I didn't want the Tempter getting to you and tearing down everything we had built up together.
- 5 For this reason, when I could stand it no longer, I sent to find out about your faith. I was afraid that in some way the tempter might have tempted you and our efforts might have been useless.
- 6 But now that Timothy is back, bringing this terrific report on your faith and love, we feel a lot better. It's especially gratifying to know that you continue to think well of us, and that you want to see us as much as we want to see you!
- 6 But Timothy has just now come to us from you and has brought good news about your faith and love. He has told us that you always have pleasant memories of us and that you long to see us, just as we also long to see you.
- 7 In the middle of our trouble and hard times here, just knowing how you're doing keeps us going.
- 7 Therefore, brothers, in all our distress and persecution we were encouraged about you because of your faith.
- 8 Knowing that your faith is alive keeps us alive.
- 8 For now we really live, since you are standing firm in the Lord.
- 9 What would be an adequate thanksgiving to offer God for all the joy we experience before him because of you?



- 9 How can we thank God enough for you in return for all the joy we have in the presence of our God because of you?
- 10 We do what we can, praying away, night and day, asking for the bonus of seeing your faces again and doing what we can to help when your faith falters.
- 10 Night and day we pray most earnestly that we may see you again and supply what is lacking in your faith.
- 11 May God our Father himself and our Master Jesus clear the road to you!
- 11 Now may our God and Father himself and our Lord Jesus clear the way for us to come to you.
- 12 And may the Master pour on the love so it fills your lives and splashes over on everyone around you, just as it does from us to you.
- 12 May the Lord make your love increase and overflow for each other and for everyone else, just as ours does for you.
- 13 May you be infused with strength and purity, filled with confidence in the presence of God our Father when our Master Jesus arrives with all his followers.
- 13 May he strengthen your hearts so that you will be blameless and holy in the presence of our God and Father when our Lord Jesus comes with all his holy ones.

## **1 Thessalonians 4**

MSG

NIV

- 1 One final word, friends. We ask you--urge is more like it--that you keep on doing what we told you to do to please God, not in a dogged religious plod, but in a living, spirited dance.
- 1 Finally, brothers, we instructed you how to live in order to please God, as in fact you are living. Now we ask you and urge you in the Lord Jesus to do this more and more.
- 2 You know the guidelines we laid out for you from the Master Jesus.
- 2 For you know what instructions we gave you by the authority of the Lord Jesus.
- 3 God wants you to live a pure life. Keep yourselves from sexual promiscuity.

- 3 It is God's will that you should be sanctified: that you should avoid sexual immorality;
- 4 Learn to appreciate and give dignity to your body,
- 4 that each of you should learn to control his own body in a way that is holy and honorable,
- 5 not abusing it, as is so common among those who know nothing of God.
- 5 not in passionate lust like the heathen, who do not know God;
- 6 Don't run roughshod over the concerns of your brothers and sisters. Their concerns are God's concerns, and he will take care of them. We've warned you about this before.
- 6 and that in this matter no one should wrong his brother or take advantage of him. The Lord will punish men for all such sins, as we have already told you and warned you.
- 7 God hasn't invited us into a disorderly, unkempt life but into something holy and beautiful--as beautiful on the inside as the outside.
- 7 For God did not call us to be impure, but to live a holy life.
- 8 If you disregard this advice, you're not offending your neighbors; you're rejecting God, who is making you a gift of his Holy Spirit.
- 8 Therefore, he who rejects this instruction does not reject man but God, who gives you his Holy Spirit.
- 9 Regarding life together and getting along with each other, you don't need me to tell you what to do. You're God-taught in these matters. Just love one another!
- 9 Now about brotherly love we do not need to write to you, for you yourselves have been taught by God to love each other.
- 10 You're already good at it; your friends all over the province of Macedonia are the evidence. Keep it up; get better and better at it.
- 10 And in fact, you do love all the brothers throughout Macedonia. Yet we urge you, brothers, to do so more and more.
- 11 Stay calm; mind your own business; do your own job. You've heard all this from us before, but a reminder never hurts.
- 11 Make it your ambition to lead a quiet life, to mind your own business and to work with your hands, just as we told you,
- 12 We want you living in a way that will command the respect of outsiders, not lying around sponging off your friends.

- 12 so that your daily life may win the respect of outsiders and so that you will not be dependent on anybody.
- 13 And regarding the question, friends, that has come up about what happens to those already dead and buried, we don't want you in the dark any longer. First off, you must not carry on over them like people who have nothing to look forward to, as if the grave were the last word.
- 13 Brothers, we do not want you to be ignorant about those who fall asleep, or to grieve like the rest of men, who have no hope.
- 14 Since Jesus died and broke loose from the grave, God will most certainly bring back to life those who died in Jesus.
- 14 We believe that Jesus died and rose again and so we believe that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in him.
- 15 And then this: We can tell you with complete confidence--we have the Master's word on it--that when the Master comes again to get us, those of us who are still alive will not get a jump on the dead and leave them behind. In actual fact, they'll be ahead of us.
- 15 According to the Lord's own word, we tell you that we who are still alive, who are left till the coming of the Lord, will certainly not precede those who have fallen asleep.
- 16 The Master himself will give the command. Archangel thunder! God's trumpet blast! He'll come down from heaven and the dead in Christ will rise--they'll go first.
- 16 For the Lord himself will come down from heaven, with a loud command, with the voice of the archangel and with the trumpet call of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first.
- 17 Then the rest of us who are still alive at the time will be caught up with them into the clouds to meet the Master.
- 17 After that, we who are still alive and are left will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And so we will be with the Lord forever.
- 18 Oh, we'll be walking on air! And then there will be one huge family reunion with the Master. So reassure one another with these words.
- 18 Therefore encourage each other with these words.

## **1 Thessalonians 5**

MSG

NIV

- 1 I don't think, friends, that I need to deal with the question of when all this is going to happen.
- 1 Now, brothers, about times and dates we do not need to write to you,
- 2 You know as well as I that the day of the Master's coming can't be posted on our calendars. He won't call ahead and make an appointment any more than a burglar would.
- 2 for you know very well that the day of the Lord will come like a thief in the night.
- 3 About the time everybody's walking around complacently, congratulating each other--"We've sure got it made! Now we can take it easy!"--suddenly everything will fall apart. It's going to come as suddenly and inescapably as birth pangs to a pregnant woman.
- 3 While people are saying, "Peace and safety," destruction will come on them suddenly, as labor pains on a pregnant woman, and they will not escape.
- 4 But friends, you're not in the dark, so how could you be taken off guard by any of this?
- 4 But you, brothers, are not in darkness so that this day should surprise you like a thief.
- 5 You're sons of Light, daughters of Day. We live under wide open skies and know where we stand.
- 5 You are all sons of the light and sons of the day. We do not belong to the night or to the darkness.
- 6 So let's not sleepwalk through life like those others. Let's keep our eyes open and be smart.
- 6 So then, let us not be like others, who are asleep, but let us be alert and self-controlled.
- 7 People sleep at night and get drunk at night.
- 7 For those who sleep, sleep at night, and those who get drunk, get drunk at night.
- 8 But not us! Since we're creatures of Day, let's act like it. Walk out into the daylight sober, dressed up in faith, love, and the hope of salvation.
- 8 But since we belong to the day, let us be self-controlled, putting on faith and love as a breastplate, and the hope of salvation as a helmet.

- 9 God didn't set us up for an angry rejection but for salvation by our Master, Jesus Christ.
- 9 For God did not appoint us to suffer wrath but to receive salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ.
- 10 He died for us, a death that triggered life. Whether we're awake with the living or asleep with the dead, we're alive with him!
- 10 He died for us so that, whether we are awake or asleep, we may live together with him.
- 11 So speak encouraging words to one another. Build up hope so you'll all be together in this, no one left out, no one left behind. I know you're already doing this; just keep on doing it.
- 11 Therefore encourage one another and build each other up, just as in fact you are doing.
- 12 And now, friends, we ask you to honor those leaders who work so hard for you, who have been given the responsibility of urging and guiding you along in your obedience.
- 12 Now we ask you, brothers, to respect those who work hard among you, who are over you in the Lord and who admonish you.
- 13 Overwhelm them with appreciation and love! Get along among yourselves, each of you doing your part.
- 13 Hold them in the highest regard in love because of their work. Live in peace with each other.
- 14 Our counsel is that you warn the freeloaders to get a move on. Gently encourage the stragglers, and reach out for the exhausted, pulling them to their feet. Be patient with each person, attentive to individual needs.
- 14 And we urge you, brothers, warn those who are idle, encourage the timid, help the weak, be patient with everyone.
- 15 And be careful that when you get on each other's nerves you don't snap at each other. Look for the best in each other, and always do your best to bring it out.
- 15 Make sure that nobody pays back wrong for wrong, but always try to be kind to each other and to everyone else.
- 16 Be cheerful no matter what;
- 16 Be joyful always;
- 17 pray all the time;
- 17 pray continually;

18 thank God no matter what happens. This is the way God wants you who belong to Christ Jesus to live.

18 give thanks in all circumstances, for this is God's will for you in Christ Jesus.

19 Don't suppress the Spirit,

19 Do not put out the Spirit's fire;

20 and don't stifle those who have a word from the Master.

20 do not treat prophecies with contempt.

21 On the other hand, don't be gullible. Check out everything, and keep only what's good.

21 Test everything. Hold on to the good.

22 Throw out anything tainted with evil.

22 Avoid every kind of evil.

23 May God himself, the God who makes everything holy and whole, make you holy and whole, put you together--spirit, soul, and body--and keep you fit for the coming of our Master, Jesus Christ.

23 May God himself, the God of peace, sanctify you through and through. May your whole spirit, soul and body be kept blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.

24 The One who called you is completely dependable. If he said it, he'll do it!

24 The one who calls you is faithful and he will do it.

25 Friends, keep up your prayers for us.

25 Brothers, pray for us.

26 Greet all the Christians there with a holy embrace.

26 Greet all the brothers with a holy kiss.

27 And make sure this letter gets read to all the brothers and sisters. Don't leave anyone out.

27 I charge you before the Lord to have this letter read to all the brothers.

28 The amazing grace of Jesus Christ be with you!

28 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.